

PEOPLES OF INDONESIA

More than 220 million people live in Indonesia, 60 percent of them packed onto the island of Java. Yet this island occupies just 7 percent of the country's total land area. Many of the other islands are barely occupied, despite their vast size. In 1950 the government began to resettle people from Java on other islands. More than 6 million people have been resettled in this way, despite opposition from local people who are sometimes moved to make way for the new settlers.

A longhouse is usually constructed of wood and bamboo.

Covered gallery

Storage area, where rice is kept in large baskets.



THE DAYAKS

The native inhabitants of Borneo, the Dayaks, are expert builders who construct elaborate longhouses on stilts. Several families live in a longhouse, each with its own cooking and sleeping quarters. Meetings are held in the covered gallery that runs along the length of the building, and rice, fish, and other foods are dried on the open verandah in front.



Women separating rice grains from the chaff

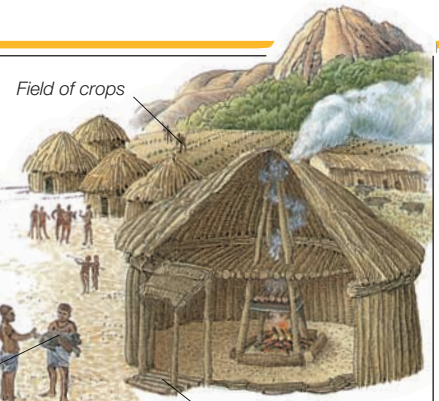
THE DANI

The people who live in Indonesia's easternmost province of Irian Jaya are related to the dark-skinned peoples of the Pacific Ocean rather than the lighter-skinned inhabitants of the rest of Southeast Asia. Among the many tribes who live in this isolated area are the Dani, whose agricultural way of life has changed little in thousands of years.

Field of crops

The Dani barter for goods, such as pigs.

Dani houses are made of wood and thatch.



THE BUGIS

The Bugis people of southern Sulawesi are famous for their seafaring skills and, in previous centuries, for their ferocity in battle. They built elegant wooden ships in which they terrorized the inhabitants of neighboring islands. It is thought that the English word "bogeyman" comes from Bugis.

The Bugis still build their wooden ships, but they now have diesel engines.

BRUNEI

SANDWICHED BETWEEN THE Malaysian state of Sarawak and the South China Sea lies Brunei. It consists of a humid tropical rain forest with a swampy plain along the coast. Once an outpost of the British Empire and a haven for pirates, this country was transformed by the discovery of oil in 1929. Today Brunei is one of the world's wealthiest nations, with huge resources of oil and natural gas.

THE SULTAN OF BRUNEI
Brunei is ruled by one of the wealthiest people on Earth. Thanks to the country's vast oil and gas reserves, Sultan Hassanal Bolkiah is worth about US\$25 billion, although he denies this figure. In recent years the Sultan has spent more than US\$450 million building one of the world's largest mosques in Brunei's capital city, Bandar Seri Begawan.



Brunei women dressed in the Muslim veil (hijab) greet the sultan.

EAST TIMOR

BEING A PORTUGUESE COLONY for 400 years, gave East Timor a very different identity to its neighbors. Most people are Roman Catholic and the country is full of Portuguese architecture. It became independent in 1975 but was taken over by its giant neighbor, Indonesia, the same year. After 26 years of war and famine, which saw the death of 200,000 East Timorese, the tiny nation finally gained independence in 2002.



STRUGGLE FOR INDEPENDENCE

East Timor began its fight to rule itself after a long guerrilla war with Indonesia, during which over 200,000 East Timorese were killed. The Revolutionary Front for an Independent East Timor (known in Portuguese as Fretilin) consists of many of these former fighters and now runs the government of the world's newest nation.

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